

player bases, but since these are among the most popular ones being played right now, we thought it should definitely be mentioned as a factor. Think about it, someone wanting to play a multiplayer or an online game purely for the “social” aspect would have a rather rude awakening when exposed to the communities on these games. Of course not everyone playing these games is a toxic douche-bag but the nice folk are rare.):

### The actual social aspect

There actually is a social aspect to online games. It's a great platform to interact with people, chill with your friends, and have a good time. You can meet people from around the world and be exposed to things you otherwise may not have the opportunity to experience. It's always nice to have company, even more so when it's for something you enjoy doing. Almost all of us here know how much fun spending an evening gaming with friends can be, and you get this from multiplayer games.

### Arrgh, where's me rum?

Piracy is a problem in the gaming industry, there's no denying it. One of the other reason devs are happy about the transition to online is because it helps reduce piracy. You can't exactly pirate an online game, sure you can download the whole thing and start it up, but if you want to play the game and want access to the servers, you're going to have to own the game. The other option for pirates then is to either play on a private server – which comes with its own set of problems – or just buy the game.

### It's all in the story

Let's be honest, if you want a story driven game with great narrative, you're not going to find it in most multiplayer games save large scale MMORPGs like WoW or GW2. This idea that all single player games are “fire-and-forget” games where you log a few hours and you're done is not true. Just look at how games like Fallout 4 and The Witcher III: Wild Hunt were easily among the best titles to release in their year, and they also happen to be single player games. And they offer well over 25-hours of



gameplay each, and that's not counting replayability value. Then there's TellTale games whose sole purpose IS the narrative. Games like Assassin's Creed Syndicate and Rise of the Tomb Raider which actually offered multiplayer elements in previous titles dropped them in favor of focusing their full attention on the single player, and guess what, they're both successful titles. Anyway what we're getting at is, these games have amazing storytelling and narrative, the kind that will immerse you and make you feel like a part of that world, something multiplayer games have not yet achieved. You can't expect this kind of attention to detail in a multiplayer game which focuses entirely on the mechanical aspect of the game. So yes, having the online component may indeed increase the longevity of a game but that can't substitute for the single player experience we get from titles like The Witcher, Mass Effect and Fallout, which are becoming increasingly rare by the day.

### Conclusion

So what did we learn from all that? Is single player truly dead? Well the answer is - not exactly. Single player is nowhere near dying. It's very likely that



all single-player games will have online elements to them, however, forcing this integration will always end in disaster, as we've already seen. We as gamers don't ALWAYS want to be connected, we want it all, the single player and the multiplayer experience. If a game dev says that story-driven single players games are dead, it's most likely because the story-driven single player games of late are crap, not because we as gamers don't want that kind of games anymore. Forcing a trend will never work, because it's not the trend that drives gamers, but the other way around. And at the end, a good game is a good game and we'd play it anyway, single player or otherwise. \*